

Steven Boada, Ph.D

Basic Information	(615) 200-0119 stevenboada@gmail.com github.com/boada linkedin.com/in/theboada	
Professional Experience	Activision Publishing, Inc. Boulder, Colorado Lead Data Scientist, Gameplay March, 2026 – Present As part of the game science team, I lead a data science team that ships ML and analytics systems into Call of Duty titles. I combine deep ML engineering background with hands-on people leadership, experimentation strategy, and cross-functional partnerships. Specifically, I: - Define and lead high-impact analytics initiatives with design leadership, analyzing how gameplay systems (maps, modes, weapons, communication systems, etc.) influence player behavior and top-line KPIs, and translating insights into actionable design recommendations. - Own experimentation strategy for gameplay features, guiding the design and evaluation of A/B tests, statistical models, and large-scale player behavior analyses. - Champion gameplay measurement strategy and data quality, partnering with engineering to improve telemetry coverage, instrumentation, and analytical reliability. - Elevate team analytical capability by mentoring data scientists, reviewing experimental designs and analyses, and promoting best practices in experimentation, statistics, and data storytelling. Senior Data Scientist, Gameplay January, 2024 – 2026 - Restarted advanced gameplay analytics support for partner studios and live Call of Duty titles. - Highlighted Project: Led study design and analysis of input advantage across controller and mouse/keyboard players, directly resulting in a rework of the aim assist system shipped in Black Ops 7 (2025). Senior Machine Learning Engineer January, 2021 – 2024 - Provided technical direction and leadership to junior data scientists end-to-end — designing, developing, and deploying recommendation systems integrated into Modern Warfare 2 (2022) and Modern Warfare 3 (2023). - Designed and maintained ML infrastructure including autoML, CI/CD pipelines (Jenkins, GitHub Actions), model tracking (MLflow), and orchestration (Airflow). - Developed near-realtime applications (via Spark streaming) to identify and mitigate in-game cheating and malicious behaviors, achieving action times in the low 10s of seconds. - Spearheaded the transition of ML infrastructure from AWS to GCP/GCS, optimizing scalability and performance. - Built customer conversion, churn prediction, and behavioral segmentation models using survival analysis, clustering, and tree-based methods. Insight Data Science New York, New York Fellow January, 2020 – 2021 - Completed a data science bootcamp focused on transitioning academics into the tech industry, working on real-world data problems. - Built a random forest model in Python to prioritize NYC restaurant inspections, improving violation detection by 2.5% and identifying critical issues up to 7 days earlier through an AWS-deployed API. Skills Machine Learning: Linear Models, Decision Trees, SVM, Clustering, Deep Learning, Survival Analysis Engineering & MLOps: Open Source Contributor, Python, Spark, SQL, MLflow, Airflow, Docker, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, AWS, GCP, Databricks Leadership: Team management, mentorship, experimental design review, cross-functional stakeholder communication, workshop facilitation, Eagle Scout AI & Agentic Systems: LLM integration (Claude, GPT), prompt engineering, agentic workflow design, multi-agent orchestration, AI coding tools (Claude Code, GitHub Copilot) Education Texas A&M University, College Station, Texas - Ph.D, Physics (astronomy focus), 2016 The University of Tennessee, Knoxville, Tennessee - M.S., Physics (astronomy focus), 2009 - B.S., Physics, 2007	